

The HFWG Template Turns R Markdown Into Publishable Lab Documents

Ada Template

Household Finance Lab

Students can write in ordinary R Markdown and produce polished PDFs and WordPress-ready companion files from one source.

Context

The HFWG template is designed for students and research assistants who already know the basics of R Markdown but do not know TeX. They can write text, code, figures, and tables in one .Rmd file, then let the template handle the PDF design.

This matters because the Lab needs consistent output across working papers, research notes, Snapshots, and blogposts. Without a template, every student has to make dozens of small design decisions. With the template, those decisions live in one shared system.

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Finding

The core workflow is simple: write once in RStudio, then knit into multiple publication formats. The PDF uses the HFWG LaTeX template. The WordPress companion uses conservative HTML that can be pasted into the CUNY Academic Commons editor without depending on special plugins.

The Snapshot format is built for short, visual-forward public communication. Its first page uses a compact header, a lead paragraph, and one featured visualization. That makes it different from a standard report, which uses a fuller title page and more traditional academic structure.

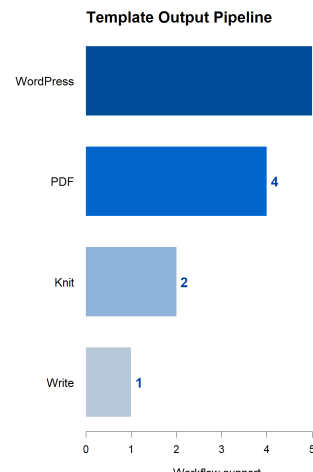
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Implication

For students, the practical lesson is that TeX is part of the production system, not something they need to edit directly. Their job is to write clear R Markdown, provide accurate YAML metadata, make readable figures, and inspect the knitted output.

For the Lab, the benefit is standardization. A research assistant can produce a PDF, a WordPress paste file, an image asset folder, and a publishing checklist from the same source document.

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Example rendering workflow for the HFWG template. The values are synthetic and are used only to test Snapshot layout, figure placement, and WordPress companion output.

Production note

This synthetic manual inspection file tests layout, figure handling, and publishing output only.

About the Author

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Writes public-facing notes on reproducible research workflows.